Maxima Grupė

Issuer review · 6M2026

Analysis date: 2026-10-22
Rating: S&P BB+, stable outlook (issuer and the 2031 notes; confirmed 2025-12-12)[1,2]
Next report: 9M 2026 results - expected November 2026

Position OK. Maxima is the largest Baltic food retailer, rated BB+ (stable) by S&P[2]. 1H EBITDA EUR 169.9m, net debt / EBITDA 2.0x[3,4]. To watch: large payouts to the shareholder cut equity to EUR 147m[5]; a competition investigation is under way in Latvia[6].

Revenue (6M2026)	EBITDA (6M2026)	Net debt / EBITDA (6M2026)	Equity (6M2026)
2,026.4 EUR m	**169.9 EUR m**	**2.0x**	**147.4 EUR m**
▲ 2.8 % vs 6M2025	▲ 0.4 % vs 6M2025	▲ 0.5x vs FY2025	▼ 43.9 % vs FY2025

Quick summary

- **Revenue up, profitability stable:** 1H revenue EUR 2,026m (+2.8%, calculated by the tool), EBITDA EUR 169.9m (169.2m), net profit EUR 85.7m[7].
- **Baltics only:** the Polish and Bulgarian businesses were sold in December 2025; 498 stores in Lithuania, Latvia and Estonia plus Barbora remain[8].
- **Large payouts to the shareholder:** EUR 423.9m of dividends in 2025, and in 1H 2026 EUR 101.0m of dividends plus a EUR 100m capital reduction; equity fell from EUR 572.9m to EUR 147.4m[5].
- **Higher debt:** net debt (incl. leases) EUR 764.5m, 2.0x EBITDA (end-2025: EUR 557.1m, 1.5x)[4,9].

Instruments held and ISINs

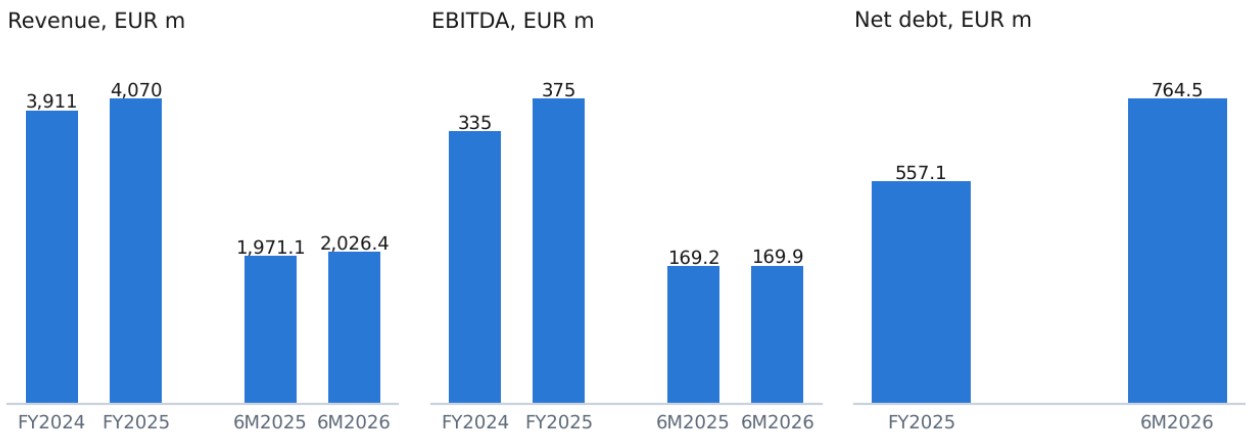
ISIN	Instrument	Coupon	Maturity	Note
XS3366323072	Maxima Grupė 4.750% senior unsecured notes 2031	4.75%	2031-05-19	EMTN; unsecured; S&P BB+

Key ratios

Metric	FY2025	6M2026	Change
Revenue, EUR m[10,11]	4,070*	2,026.4*	▲ 2.8 % vs 6M2025
EBITDA, EUR m[10,3]	375*	169.9*	▲ 0.4 % vs 6M2025
Net profit, EUR m[12,11]	208.7ᶜ	85.7*	▲ 55.0 % vs 6M2025
Investments, EUR m[9,13]	74.3*	48.4*	▼ 32.7 % vs 6M2025
Net debt, EUR m[9,4]	557.1*	764.5*	▲ 37.2 % vs FY2025
Net debt / EBITDA[9,4]	1.5x*	**2.0x***	▲ 0.5x vs FY2025
Equity, EUR m[11]	262.9*	147.4*	▼ 43.9 % vs FY2025
Equity ratio[11]	15.2%ᶜ	**8.4%ᶜ**	▼ 6.8 p. p. vs FY2025
Total assets, EUR m[11]	1,725.7*	1,763.8*	▲ 2.2 % vs FY2025

Colours: green change – the metric is improving, red – worsening. Latest-period cell background: green – good level, amber – average, red – weak (tool benchmarks, config/metric_rules.yaml).

* – taken from the report summary; ᶜ – calculated by the tool. Small numbers next to text link to the source (opens the document at the cited page).



Business performance review

- **Strategy is price leadership in the Baltics:** 1H price cuts on 9,000 products in Lithuania and 4,000 in Latvia; more than 80 stores to be opened or expanded by 2030[14,4].
- Latvian property company Irbis A was bought on 2026-05-31 (EUR 16.9m); SOLLO was sold on 2026-08-31[15].

Financials

- FY2025 (continuing operations) revenue EUR 4,070m, EBITDA EUR 375m, margin 9.2%[10].
- Cash EUR 256.3m at 2026-06-30; bank loans EUR 259.3m (EUR 260m SEB/ING bridge loan, plus EUR 40m Swedbank and EUR 40m SEB)[16,8].

Past plans vs outcomes

Plan / target	Outcome	What changed and why	Status
Focus on the Baltics by selling Poland and Bulgaria	Sale completed on 2025-12-19 and 2025-12-22[17,18]	Done[17].	**Met**
Refinance the short-term loan with bonds	EUR 350m of bonds issued in May 2026; most of the proceeds repay the loan[2,19]	Done[2].	**Met**
Cut Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 42% by 2030 (vs 2021)	Down 24.5% by end-2025[20]	In progress[20].	**In progress**
Open or expand >80 stores by 2030	New target[14]	New plan[14].	**In progress**

Investor information & conclusions

- **Instrument held:** 4.750% unsecured notes, EUR 350m, issued 2026-05-19, maturing 2031-05-19, annual coupon; Nasdaq Vilnius and Euronext Dublin; S&P BB+[21,2,19].
- **Leverage:** net debt / EBITDA 2.0x – moderate; cash of EUR 256m[4,11]. No other bonds – the 2022 6.25% bonds were redeemed early on 2025-10-27[22].
- **Risk:** large payouts to the shareholder reduce the capital buffer; no dividend policy found. Call terms and covenants were not found in the reports.
- **Conclusion:** moderate risk – stable business and a BB+ rating, but the shareholder takes out a lot of cash.

ESG report

Exclusionary screening (companies)

☑ Yes, the company is not involved in excluded sectors: controversial and nuclear weapons, tobacco, gambling and restricted sectors in fossil fuel

- Food retail
- No activity in excluded sectors[1].

☑ Yes, the company does not have red flag/signal related to controversies based on UN Global Compact, OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises or any other relevant principles/standards

- No UN Global Compact or OECD related controversies found.

☐ Yes, the company is not in the list of sanctions (add a screenshot)

Needs review

- Automatic check against the EU, UN, US OFAC and UK consolidated sanctions lists.

☐ Yes, issues were not identified from adverse media checks (add a screenshot)

- Found: on 2025-11-06 the Latvian Competition Council fined Maxima Latvija more than EUR 1.8m for unfair trading practices
- The company disagrees and appeals[23].
- On 2026-02-26 the Council took procedural actions at Maxima Latvija's office over a suspected cartel between the two largest retailers
- The investigation is ongoing, no fine yet[6].

In case any red flags, risks, unclarities were identified then additional checks (sanctions screening and adverse media checks) on the company's Ultimate Beneficial Owners and/or senior management shall be performed.

Additional comments:

ESG integration and positive screening (positive answers imply higher allocation)

☑ Yes, the company is promoting environmental or social characteristics (activities, ESG policy, good ESG rating, etc)

- Renewable energy 37.1% (2025), 85% of waste diverted from landfill, food donations to food banks (EUR 6.3m)[20].

☑ Yes, the activities of the company or it's strategy is aligned with the taxonomy and/or Paris agreement targets (e.g. net zero commitment)

- Target to cut Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 42% by 2030 (vs 2021)
- 24.5% achieved[20].

☐ Yes, the company does not have yellow flag/signal related to controversies based on UN Global Compact or any other relevant principles/standards

- Yellow flag: Latvian competition fine and cartel investigation[23,6].

☑ Yes, the company fulfills the expectations from SEB thematic and sector policies

Applicable

- The Agriculture policy (food trading)[24].

Met

- A sustainability report in the annual report, an emission reduction target[25].

Additional comments:

Engagement

☐ Is there a need for pro-active engagement with the company?

- No need: the competition matters are being handled in court and in the investigation.

Additional comments:

Indicators

☑ Yes, the indicators of the company support the targets of sustainability and PAI indicators followed by the Fund

- Emissions, renewable energy share and waste figures are reported[20].

Additional comments:

Conclusion: No exclusions or red flags. Yellow flag – competition law matters in Latvia.

SEB policies applied: Policy on Sustainability Considerations in Investments (SEB AB); Agriculture, Fishing, Aquaculture and Animal Welfare sector policy; Environmental Policy on Climate, Nature and Water (thematic); Social and Human Rights Policy (thematic); Governance expectations in sector policies (anti-corruption, tax, reporting)

Sources

1. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 6, 2026-04-07
2. Maxima Grupė - Results of the EUR 350m 5-year bond offering, 2026-05-08
3. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 7, 2026-09-04
4. Maxima Grupė - Press release: 2026 m. pirmasis pusmetis, 2026-09-04
5. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 3-4, 9, 2026-09-04
6. LSM - Cartel suspected between two food retailers in Latvia, 2026-02-27
7. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 3, 7, 2026-09-04
8. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 5-6, 2026-04-07
9. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 8, 2026-04-07
10. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 7, 2026-04-07
11. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 3, 2026-09-04
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14. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 10, 2026-04-07
15. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 9-10, 2026-09-04
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17. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 10, 2026-09-04
18. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 5, 2026-04-07
19. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 8, 2026-09-04
20. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 3, 2026-04-07
21. Maxima Grupė - Bond issue page, 2026
22. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 4-5, 2026-04-07
23. LSM - Maxima Latvia hit with EUR 1.8 million fine for unfair trading practices, 2025-11-06
24. SEB Agriculture, Fishing, Aquaculture and Animal Welfare sector policy (2026-04-23), p. 5-10, 2026-04-23
25. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 3, 53-97, 2026-04-07

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